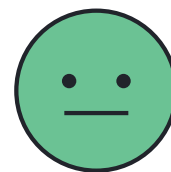
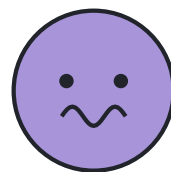
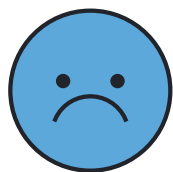




TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Ride the Wave

Understanding & Managing Anger - A Workbook for Teens

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 Understanding Anger
- 2 My Anger Signals & Triggers
- 3 Cooling Down
- 4 What's Under the Anger
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: Understanding Anger

Anger is normal; harm is optional.



Anger Is a Messenger

Anger is a normal, healthy emotion - it often shows up when something feels unfair, when you're hurt, or when a boundary gets crossed. Anger itself isn't the problem. What we DO with it can be.

Managing anger doesn't mean never feeling it or stuffing it down. It means feeling it, understanding its message, and expressing it in ways that don't damage you or others.

Anger often masks

- ☐ Hurt or embarrassment.
- ☐ Fear or feeling out of control.
- ☐ Feeling disrespected or unheard.
- ☐ Exhaustion, hunger, or stress.



The Anger Escalator

Anger usually builds in steps, like riding an escalator up: annoyed, frustrated, angry, furious. The higher you go, the harder it is to think clearly. The trick is to notice the early steps and step off before the top.

Once you're at the top (flooded), your thinking brain goes offline. That's why the best move is often to pause and cool down BEFORE responding.

Stepping off early

- ☐ Learn your first warning signs.
- ☐ Use a cool-down before you react.
- ☐ Come back to the issue once you're calm.



Part 2: My Anger Signals & Triggers

Know your warning signs.



My Anger Thermometer

A feelings thermometer shows how BIG a feeling is. Green is calm and okay. Yellow is starting to bubble. Red is a very big feeling. Knowing our level helps us pick the right calm-down tool.



RED - Big feeling



YELLOW - Getting bigger



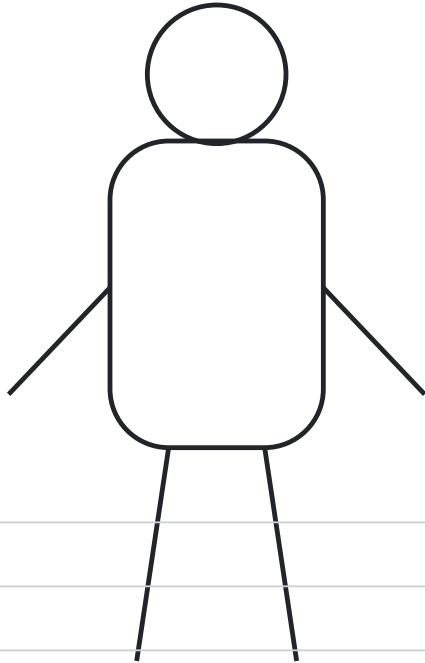
GREEN - Calm & okay

What can I do at each level? Write above.



Where I Feel Anger

Big feelings live in our bodies too. Anger might feel hot in your chest. Worry might feel like butterflies in your tummy. Color or mark where you feel your feelings.



Draw or color:

-  Hot / angry feelings
-  Fluttery / worried feelings
-  Heavy / sad feelings
-  Calm / good feelings

Today my body feels...



My Anger Trigger Log

When you feel stressed or overwhelmed, logging it helps you understand your triggers and what actually helps. Fill one row when a stressful moment happens.

- 1** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 2** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 3** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 4** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____



Part 3: Cooling Down

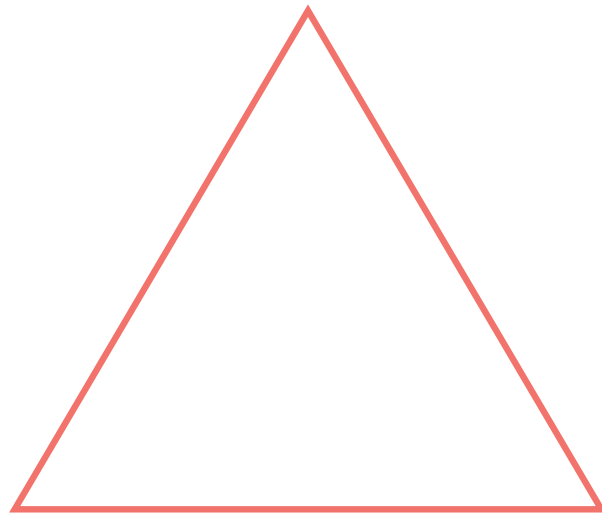
Cool the body before you speak.



Cool-Down Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Slow Belly Breathing



1. Breathe in slowly through your nose for 4.
2. Feel your belly (not chest) expand.
3. Breathe out for 6, longer than the in-breath.
4. Repeat until you step down the escalator.

Anger Cool-Down Menu



Tick tools to try in the heat of the moment; star what works.

In the moment

- ☐ Walk away to cool off (say 'I need a minute').
- ☐ Slow your breathing right down.
- ☐ Count backward from 20.
- ☐ Push against a wall or squeeze something.

Release the energy

- ☐ Go for a run or move hard for a few minutes.
- ☐ Rip or scribble on scrap paper.
- ☐ Blast and move to music.

After you cool down

- ☐ Use 'I feel...' statements instead of blame.
- ☐ Fix what you can; repair if you hurt someone.
- ☐ Figure out what the anger was really about.



Part 4: What's Under the Anger

Anger is often the tip of the iceberg.



Reframing Anger Thoughts

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

6. How I feel now:



Under My Anger

Think of a recent time you got angry. What was really underneath it?

What did you need in that moment that you weren't getting?



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Practice the pause.



Anger Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 Someone blames you for something you didn't do.

What could you do?

2 A sibling takes or breaks your stuff.

What could you do?

3 You feel disrespected by a teacher or coach.

What could you do?



Anger Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 A friend spreads a rumor about you.

What could you do?

2 You lose an important game or competition.

What could you do?

3 Someone provokes you online.

What could you do?

My Anger Management Plan



Your plan for handling anger without regret.

My earliest anger warning signs:

My go-to cool-down moves:

How I'll express anger without harm:

How I'll repair things if I slip:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

My Notes & Reflections



Lined area for notes and reflections, consisting of 20 horizontal lines.



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